

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Prevent and Protect, Azure and Hybrid Infrastructure Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience implementing security controls and improving security posture across hybrid on-premises and cloud infrastructure. I specialise in the prevent and protect pillars of cyber security, with deep expertise in Microsoft Azure security, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), vulnerability management, and identity security using Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)). I am currently delivering enterprise-scale cyber security at the University of the Arts London (UAL) across an 8,000-user environment, and I am looking to bring that breadth of operational and engineering experience to a forward-thinking retail organisation where I can strengthen security across a complex hybrid infrastructure and Azure cloud estate on a fully remote basis.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Prevent and Protect Controls:** Security control design and implementation, security hardening, CIS Controls, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Azure and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security architecture, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure AD), Conditional Access policies, Azure security policies and compliance, hybrid cloud and on-premises environment security
- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL (Kusto Query Language) query and rule authoring, CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), alert triage, detection engineering, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR)
- **EDR and Endpoint Protection:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Tanium
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- **Device and Mobile Security:** Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), device compliance policies, bring-your-own-device (BYOD) management
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, risk-based vulnerability prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, containment and eradication procedures
- **Email and Network Security:** Mimecast email security gateway, Check Point Harmony firewall, Web Application Firewall (WAF), Intrusion Detection System (IDS) and Intrusion Prevention System (IPS)
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR playbook automation, security reporting and executive dashboards

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer March 2025 - Present
Supporting the prevent and protect pillars of cyber security across hybrid on-premises and cloud infrastructure serving 8,000 users, operating within the prevent, detect and respond pillars of the university's cyber security strategy.

- Administer Microsoft Azure security configuration and Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) including Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO and privileged identity management (PIM) to enforce zero-trust security principles across the cloud and hybrid estate.
- Manage Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, authoring KQL detection rules and correlation analytics to identify advanced threats; own alert triage, investigation and incident response workflows in line with NIST 800-61.

- Lead CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight and Discover operations, driving proactive threat hunting, detection engineering and continuous improvement of endpoint visibility and protection.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, integrating these platforms with Microsoft Sentinel for unified detection, investigation and response across endpoints, identity and cloud workloads.
- Oversee Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM to enforce device compliance, application management and data protection policies across corporate and BYOD endpoints within the hybrid infrastructure.
- Run vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck and Nessus, providing continuous identification of exploitable security gaps and coordinating risk-prioritised remediation across IT and infrastructure teams.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM for privileged access governance, session recording and credential vaulting across the enterprise.
- Manage Check Point Harmony firewall policies, WAF and DDoS protections, and IDS/IPS configurations to protect internet-facing applications and internal network segments.
- Develop PowerShell automation scripts and SOAR playbooks to accelerate Security Operations Centre (SOC) alert handling, enrichment and containment, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Manage Mimecast email security gateway, including anti-phishing, anti-spoofing and Data Loss Prevention (DLP) controls protecting the organisation's communication channels.
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulation programmes; produce security posture reports for the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and senior leadership.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst - Cyber Security and Identity
 Implemented and maintained preventive and detective security controls across the university's hybrid infrastructure and Azure cloud environment, including endpoint protection, identity security and SIEM monitoring. *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) security, including Conditional Access policy configuration, MFA enforcement, SSO management and identity lifecycle governance for 8,000 users.
- Supported the enterprise deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, configuring detection policies and onboarding endpoints to the Azure security ecosystem.
- Monitored and triaged Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR alerts, investigating and containing threats in line with NIST 800-61 incident response procedures.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus across the hybrid infrastructure; produced risk-rated reports and tracked remediation with system owners through to closure.
- Supported Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM device compliance management, maintaining security baseline policies for corporate and BYOD devices.
- Used Tanium for real-time endpoint visibility, patch status monitoring and on-demand remediation across the hybrid on-premises and cloud-managed estate.
- Assisted with BeyondTrust PAM platform administration, including privileged account provisioning, periodic access reviews and session monitoring.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus, ISO 27001 and NIST CSF compliance activities, evidencing preventive and detective security controls for audit and certification purposes.

HGX Solutions Ltd (Snazle Tech) - IT Engineer - Security, Quality and Infrastructure
 Implemented preventive and detective security controls across a cloud-native SaaS/Tech infrastructure, including endpoint security, firewall policies and network access controls. *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Administered Azure Active Directory and identity and access management (IAM) including MFA, SSO and RBAC for internal users and third-party vendor accounts, reducing the organisation's credential-based attack surface.
- Supported vulnerability assessment and penetration test remediation activities, aligning findings to ISO 27001 controls and producing tracked remediation plans.
- Managed MDM and device security policies for a remote-first workforce, ensuring endpoint compliance and data protection standards were maintained across the hybrid working environment.
- Developed security policies, incident response procedures and security awareness training materials aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials standards.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led end-to-end implementation of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight and Discover across UAL's 8,000-user hybrid environment, establishing a mature and intelligence-driven endpoint protection and detection capability.
- Delivered enterprise-wide Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft 365 Defender deployment for 8,000 users across the hybrid infrastructure, integrating with Microsoft Sentinel to create a unified Azure-native detect and respond capability.
- Attained Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, validating expertise across all eight security domains including security architecture, cloud security and security operations.
- Introduced Pentera Breach Attack Simulation (BAS) for continuous automated security validation, enabling proactive identification and remediation of exploitable vulnerabilities before adversaries could leverage them.
- Designed and deployed SOAR automation and PowerShell scripting workflows, significantly reducing manual SOC triage effort and improving the organisation's ability to scale threat detection across the hybrid estate.
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, systematically evidencing preventive security controls across the hybrid cloud and on-premises environment.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP85,000-100,000 | Fully Remote (UK)